Books to gather

Borrow physical copies or authorized editions; exact page numbers depend on the edition.

Room on the Broom

Julia Donaldson | Picture-book fiction

Prepare: witch and animal figures, toy broom, hat/bow/wand cards

Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book fiction

Prepare: small pumpkin, character figures, ribbon for a pretend vine

Pumpkin Soup

Helen Cooper | Picture-book fiction

Prepare: cat, squirrel and duck figures; bowl and spoon

Too Many Pumpkins

Linda White | Picture-book fiction

Prepare: Rebecca Estelle figure, pumpkin photos, garden mat, pretend food cards

The Pumpkin Book

Gail Gibbons | Informational picture book

Prepare: real pumpkin or pumpkin photo, seed, vine/flower/pumpkin photographs

A Chair for My Mother

Vera B. Williams | Realistic fiction

Prepare: Jar, pretend coins, chair photo or toy chair, family figures.

Action Jackson

Jan Greenberg and Sandra Jordan; illustrated by Robert Andrew Parker | Informational picture-book biography

Prepare: Paper, paint or washable paint substitute, brush, art-material photos and a finished classroom artwork.

Seasonal books and investigations

Stacie's books are the teaching texts, with hands-on access to the grade-level skills.

Week 1 | Room on the Broom

Julia Donaldson | witch, cat, dog, bird and frog props; pretend broom

Grade 3: Name a character and show how an animal helps the witch. Grade 4: Show how the animals work together to help the witch. Point to an illustration that supports your answer.

Week 2 | Big Pumpkin

Julia Donaldson | witch, cat, dog, bird and frog props; pretend broom

Grade 3: Name a character and show how an animal helps the witch. Grade 4: Show how the animals work together to help the witch. Point to an illustration that supports your answer.

Week 3 | Pumpkin Soup

Erica Silverman | pumpkin photo or small pumpkin; character cards; ribbon

Grade 3: Identify who tries to pull the pumpkin and sequence two attempts. Grade 4: Explain how the bat's idea helps the group solve the problem. Show an illustration that supports the solution.

Week 4 | Too Many Pumpkins

Helen Cooper | cat, squirrel and duck props; bowl and spoon

Grade 3: Sequence the problem and the friends' response. Grade 4: Explain how the friends' actions affect one another. Use an illustration to explain how the problem is resolved.

Week 5 | The Pumpkin Book

Linda White | pumpkin photos; garden mat; baskets

Grade 3: Show what changes for Rebecca Estelle during the story. Grade 4: Explain how her response to the pumpkins changes. Point to a scene that supports a message about sharing.

Week 6 | A Chair for My Mother

Linda White | pumpkin photos; garden mat; baskets

Grade 3: Show what changes for Rebecca Estelle during the story. Grade 4: Explain how her response to the pumpkins changes. Point to a scene that supports a message about sharing.

Informational reading

The Pumpkin Book by Gail Gibbons replaces the former flag book in weeks 1-2. Identify the central idea, find a real growth fact and connect the fact to the idea. Keep this informational strand alongside Room on the Broom.

2026-10-23 | Science investigation

Pumpkin push investigation: use a lightweight pumpkin model on a tray. Grade 3 predicts and compares a push and pull (3.7B). Grade 4 rolls a toy car into the stationary model and observes energy transfer (4.8A). Repeat three trials with the same surface. Save one prediction, observation and explanation per learner.

2026-11-06 | Science investigation

Pumpkin sound investigation: shake an adult-sealed container of dried pumpkin seeds softly. Grade 3 identifies sound energy (3.8A). Grade 4 compares sound on/off beside a light paper membrane to look for vibration as evidence of sound energy transfer (4.8A). If no movement is visible, record that result and use the teacher's tested sound demonstration.

2026-11-20 | Science investigation

Leaf-and-ramp investigation: first observe and sort collected leaves by visible features as ungraded exploration. Test the same toy car on a bare ramp and a securely fixed dry-leaf surface. Grade 3 compares speed and the distance a foam block moves after contact (3.8B); Grade 4 describes the friction pattern (4.7). Keep car, release point and ramp height constant; repeat three trials. Do not infer energy from leaf color. Grade 3 uses the same car and foam block for slow/faster trials, resets the block each time and compares the effects. Grade 4 changes only the track surface for the friction comparison.

2026-12-11 | Science investigation

Design-and-test lab: reuse the familiar ramp setup. Grade 3 demonstrates a motion/energy finding (3.8B). Grade 4 tests smooth and textured surfaces for a friction pattern (4.7). Make one planned change, repeat three times, and use a photo or model to explain the evidence. Grade 3 uses the same car and foam block for slow/faster trials, resets the block each time and compares the effects. Grade 4 changes only the track surface for the friction comparison.

Access and evidence

Props, pictures and AAC support the response. Return to the actual book or investigation evidence. Record accuracy and prompts separately; use three observations on lab Fridays.

Week 1 | Real-book guide

October 13 to 16 | People solve problems

Grade 3 | Room on the Broom

Julia Donaldson | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

witch and animal figures, toy broom, hat/bow/wand cards The witch loses belongings; animals help retrieve them and join her. The animals later help save her from the dragon.

2026-10-13: Choose important details about pumpkin growth and use them to explain a key idea. (TEKS 3.6G)

2026-10-14: Put pictured stages of pumpkin growth in order. (TEKS 3.7D)

2026-10-15: Show how a growth detail supports the book's main idea. (TEKS 3.9D(i))

2026-10-16: State the main idea and show one supporting pumpkin fact. (TEKS 3.9D(i))

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Room on the Broom

Julia Donaldson | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

witch and animal figures, toy broom, hat/bow/wand cards The witch loses belongings; animals help retrieve them and join her. The animals later help save her from the dragon.

2026-10-13: Explain why the witch gives a helper a place on the broom. (TEKS 4.8B)

2026-10-14: Use the animals' actions to explain how they solve the danger. (TEKS 4.8C)

2026-10-15: Explain a message about helping, using a scene as evidence. (TEKS 4.8A)

2026-10-16: Explain how cooperation changes the outcome, using book evidence. (TEKS 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.

Week 2 | Real-book guide

October 19 to 23 | Show what changed

Grade 3 | Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

small pumpkin, character figures, ribbon for a pretend vine The witch cannot pull the pumpkin free. Others try; the bat suggests working together.

2026-10-19: Identify what the pumpkin book teaches us about. (TEKS 3.9D(i))

2026-10-20: Choose important details about pumpkin growth and use them to explain a key idea. (TEKS 3.6G)

2026-10-21: Put pictured stages of pumpkin growth in order. (TEKS 3.7D)

2026-10-22: Show how a growth detail supports the book's main idea. (TEKS 3.9D(i))

2026-10-23: State the main idea and show one supporting pumpkin fact. (TEKS 3.9D(i))

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

small pumpkin, character figures, ribbon for a pretend vine The witch cannot pull the pumpkin free. Others try; the bat suggests working together.

2026-10-19: Explain how an animal's help changes what the witch does. (TEKS 4.8B)

2026-10-20: Explain why the witch gives a helper a place on the broom. (TEKS 4.8B)

2026-10-21: Use the animals' actions to explain how they solve the danger. (TEKS 4.8C)

2026-10-22: Explain a message about helping, using a scene as evidence. (TEKS 4.8A)

2026-10-23: Explain how cooperation changes the outcome, using book evidence. (TEKS 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.

Week 3 | Real-book guide

October 26 to 30 | Characters take action

Grade 3 | Pumpkin Soup

Helen Cooper | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

cat, squirrel and duck figures; bowl and spoon The friends have familiar soup-making jobs. Duck wants to stir; a disagreement and his absence disrupt the group.

2026-10-26: Identify the problem: the pumpkin will not come free. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-10-27: Put two characters' attempts in story order. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-10-28: Show how the characters work together to pull the pumpkin. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-10-29: Use dialogue and character roles to act the pumpkin problem and solution. (TEKS 3.9C)

2026-10-30: Retell the problem, group action and result. (TEKS 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Pumpkin Soup

Helen Cooper | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

cat, squirrel and duck figures; bowl and spoon The friends have familiar soup-making jobs. Duck wants to stir; a disagreement and his absence disrupt the group.

2026-10-26: Explain why the characters' separate attempts do not solve the problem. (TEKS 4.8C)

2026-10-27: Compare the bat's idea with the earlier attempts. (TEKS 4.8B)

2026-10-28: Explain how the bat's idea changes the result. (TEKS 4.8C)

2026-10-29: Support a message about teamwork with the pumpkin-pulling scene. (TEKS 4.8A)

2026-10-30: Explain why the solution works, using the book as evidence. (TEKS 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.

Week 4 | Real-book guide

November 2 to 6 | Listen and find evidence

Grade 3 | Too Many Pumpkins

Linda White | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

Rebecca Estelle figure, pumpkin photos, garden mat, pretend food cards Rebecca Estelle does not want pumpkins, but they grow in her yard. She eventually uses and shares them.

2026-11-04: Sequence the disagreement, search and reunion. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-11-05: Show a helpful action that repairs the friendship. (TEKS 3.8B)

2026-11-06: Retell the problem and solution with pictures. (TEKS 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Too Many Pumpkins

Linda White | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

Rebecca Estelle figure, pumpkin photos, garden mat, pretend food cards Rebecca Estelle does not want pumpkins, but they grow in her yard. She eventually uses and shares them.

2026-11-04: Explain how the friends' choices change the problem. (TEKS 4.8C)

2026-11-05: Use a scene to explain a message about sharing responsibilities. (TEKS 4.8A)

2026-11-06: Explain how the friends solve their disagreement, with book evidence. (TEKS 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.

Week 5 | Real-book guide

November 9 to 13 | Small actions help

Grade 3 | The Pumpkin Book

Gail Gibbons | Informational picture book

Prepare

real pumpkin or pumpkin photo, seed, vine/flower/pumpkin photographs Use the real book's explanation of pumpkin growth; bookmark the relevant pages in the available edition.

2026-11-09: Identify Rebecca Estelle's pumpkin problem. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-11-10: Sequence how the unwanted pumpkins grow. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-11-11: Show what she makes from the pumpkins. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-11-12: Show how sharing changes the situation. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-11-13: Retell the pumpkin problem, action and result. (TEKS 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | The Pumpkin Book

Gail Gibbons | Informational picture book

Prepare

real pumpkin or pumpkin photo, seed, vine/flower/pumpkin photographs Use the real book's explanation of pumpkin growth; bookmark the relevant pages in the available edition.

2026-11-09: Explain how Rebecca Estelle feels about pumpkins at the beginning. (TEKS 4.8B)

2026-11-10: Explain how she responds when the pumpkins keep growing. (TEKS 4.8B)

2026-11-11: Compare her response at the beginning and near the end. (TEKS 4.8B)

2026-11-12: Use a scene to support a message about sharing with others. (TEKS 4.8A)

2026-11-13: Explain how her actions and attitude change, using evidence. (TEKS 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

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Week 6 | Real-book guide

November 16 to 20 | Observe and explain

Grade 3 | A Chair for My Mother

Vera B. Williams | Realistic fiction

Prepare

Jar, pretend coins, chair photo or toy chair, family figures. Bookmark saving coins, community help and selecting the chair. Preview the fire-related scenes and use a familiar saving/helping scene as the first access point.

2026-11-16: Identify Rebecca Estelle's pumpkin problem. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-11-17: Sequence how the unwanted pumpkins grow. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-11-18: Show what she makes from the pumpkins. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-11-19: Show how sharing changes the situation. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-11-20: Retell the pumpkin problem, action and result. (TEKS 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | A Chair for My Mother

Vera B. Williams | Realistic fiction

Prepare

Jar, pretend coins, chair photo or toy chair, family figures. Bookmark saving coins, community help and selecting the chair. Preview the fire-related scenes and use a familiar saving/helping scene as the first access point.

2026-11-16: Explain how Rebecca Estelle feels about pumpkins at the beginning. (TEKS 4.8B)

2026-11-17: Explain how she responds when the pumpkins keep growing. (TEKS 4.8B)

2026-11-18: Compare her response at the beginning and near the end. (TEKS 4.8B)

2026-11-19: Use a scene to support a message about sharing with others. (TEKS 4.8A)

2026-11-20: Explain how her actions and attitude change, using evidence. (TEKS 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.

Week 7 | Real-book guide

November 30 to December 4 | Create together

Grade 3 | Action Jackson

Jan Greenberg and Sandra Jordan; illustrated by Robert Andrew Parker | Informational picture-book biography

Prepare

Paper, paint or washable paint substitute, brush, art-material photos and a finished classroom artwork. Bookmark the artist, canvas laid on the floor, painting process and finished painting. Use a short selected spread rather than the complete biography for each check.

2026-11-30: Identify the character's problem. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-12-01: Show how one character responds to another. (TEKS 3.8B)

2026-12-02: Sequence the problem, action and result. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-12-03: Use a scene to explain the story's message. (TEKS 3.8A)

2026-12-04: Explain a character's action using book evidence. (TEKS 3.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Action Jackson

Jan Greenberg and Sandra Jordan; illustrated by Robert Andrew Parker | Informational picture-book biography

Prepare

Paper, paint or washable paint substitute, brush, art-material photos and a finished classroom artwork. Bookmark the artist, canvas laid on the floor, painting process and finished painting. Use a short selected spread rather than the complete biography for each check.

2026-11-30: Identify what the book is mostly about. (TEKS 4.9D(i))

2026-12-01: Choose important details about the artist and use them to explain a key idea. (TEKS 4.6G)

2026-12-02: Connect a fact to the central idea. (TEKS 4.9D(i))

2026-12-03: Use a book detail to support an answer. (TEKS 4.7C)

2026-12-04: State the central idea and show supporting evidence. (TEKS 4.9D(i))

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.

Week 8 | Real-book guide

December 7 to 11 | Use evidence to improve a design

Grade 3 | Room on the Broom

Julia Donaldson | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

witch and animal figures, toy broom, hat/bow/wand cards The witch loses belongings; animals help retrieve them and join her. The animals later help save her from the dragon.

2026-12-07: Identify the character's problem. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-12-08: Show how one character responds to another. (TEKS 3.8B)

2026-12-09: Sequence the problem, action and result. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-12-10: Use a scene to explain the story's message. (TEKS 3.8A)

2026-12-11: Explain a character's action using book evidence. (TEKS 3.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Room on the Broom

Julia Donaldson | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

witch and animal figures, toy broom, hat/bow/wand cards The witch loses belongings; animals help retrieve them and join her. The animals later help save her from the dragon.

2026-12-07: Identify what the book is mostly about. (TEKS 4.9D(i))

2026-12-08: Choose important details about the artist and use them to explain a key idea. (TEKS 4.6G)

2026-12-09: Connect a fact to the central idea. (TEKS 4.9D(i))

2026-12-10: Use a book detail to support an answer. (TEKS 4.7C)

2026-12-11: State the central idea and show supporting evidence. (TEKS 4.9D(i))

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

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Week 9 | Real-book guide

December 14 to 18 | Show what you learned

Grade 3 | Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

small pumpkin, character figures, ribbon for a pretend vine The witch cannot pull the pumpkin free. Others try; the bat suggests working together.

2026-12-14: Identify the character's problem. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-12-15: Show how one character responds to another. (TEKS 3.8B)

2026-12-16: Sequence the problem, action and result. (TEKS 3.8C)

2026-12-17: Use a scene to explain the story's message. (TEKS 3.8A)

2026-12-18: Explain a character's action using book evidence. (TEKS 3.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

small pumpkin, character figures, ribbon for a pretend vine The witch cannot pull the pumpkin free. Others try; the bat suggests working together.

2026-12-14: Identify what the book is mostly about. (TEKS 4.9D(i))

2026-12-15: Choose important details about the artist and use them to explain a key idea. (TEKS 4.6G)

2026-12-16: Connect a fact to the central idea. (TEKS 4.9D(i))

2026-12-17: Use a book detail to support an answer. (TEKS 4.7C)

2026-12-18: State the central idea and show supporting evidence. (TEKS 4.9D(i))

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

Borrow a physical book or authorized library/publisher edition. These guides contain teaching prompts, not reproductions of the books. HMH supplies the grade-level reading, writing, drama and spelling selections.

Reading response and story mats

Pair these labels with real book illustrations, objects or the student's existing symbols.

Character / topic	Problem / key idea
Action / important detail	Result / what the detail shows

Return to the book

Book _____ Page / scene _____ My answer _____ The book shows _____ Teacher: record the response and help separately. Picture matching alone does not demonstrate a theme or central idea.

First, next, then

Use for a taught sequence. Add real photos, props or symbols.

First	Next	Then

Independent routine

First: familiar task _____ Then: finished basket / planned break _____ Help signal _____ Finish after ____ items.

Writing and source-evidence frames

Use the actual book, photo, map or history source. A frame supports composition; it is not an answer key.

Reading response | 3.7B

In _____, I learned / noticed _____. The page shows _____.

Compare sources | 4.7B

Both _____ and _____ show _____. They differ because _____. My evidence is _____.

Story message

The topic is _____. The message is _____. The character's action _____ supports it.

History claim | 3.14F

My claim: _____. Source title / creator / date: _____. This detail supports it: _____.

Texas history

Person / event: _____. What happened: _____. A cause or effect: _____. Source evidence: _____.

Teacher record

Response method: _____. Planned access: _____. Extra prompt: _____. Next step: _____.

Equal groups and sharing mat

Math: 3.4D, 3.4E, 3.4H, 3.4J; supported division models for 4.4E.

Make equal groups to multiply, or share the total equally to divide. Tell whether the unknown is the number of groups or the number in each group.

Group 1	Group 2	Group 3

Connect model and equation

____ groups of ____ = ____ total. ____ divided by ____ = ____. Related multiplication fact: _____

Fresh response

New total / groups: _____ Student response: _____ Extra help: _____

Equal-length fraction strips

Math: 3.3A/C/D/F/G/H and 4.3A/B/C/D/E

Each row is the same-size whole. Print at actual size. Cut individual parts only after comparing equal whole lengths.

Whole	1						
2 equal parts	1/2	1/2					
3 equal parts	1/3	1/3	1/3				
4 equal parts	1/4	1/4	1/4	1/4			
6 equal parts	1/6	1/6	1/6	1/6	1/6	1/6	
8 equal parts	1/8	1/8	1/8	1/8	1/8	1/8	1/8	1/8

Build, compare, explain

Build 3/4 from unit fractions. Compare 1/2 with 2/4, then 1/2 with 3/4. Record an equation or comparison and show why it is true.

Array, area and perimeter mat

Math: 3.4D/E; 4.5C/D

Use each square as one square unit. Outline a 2-by-3 rectangle. Count tiles inside for area and unit edges around it for perimeter.

Connect the formulas

Area: ____ rows x ____ columns = ____ square units. Perimeter: ____ + ____ + ____ + ____ = ____ units.
Explain how your model supports the formula: _____

Science investigation record

Student _____ Date _____ TEKS _____

Our question

What will we test? _____

Plan and predict

I think _____ because _____. What stays the same? _____ What changes? _____

Observe three trials

Trial 1: _____ Trial 2: _____ Trial 3: _____

Explain with evidence

I observed _____. This supports _____ because _____.

Energy investigation

Same car and block; slow/faster runs. Record observed speed and effect on the block. Reset and repeat.

Mixture investigation

Mass before: ____ Mass after: ____ Same closed container, no spills. What do these readings show?

Teacher evidence

Correct / total: ____ Extra prompts: ____ Response method: ____ Next step: ____

Choose this week's licensed lessons

Week ____ Grade 3 learner _____ Grade 4 learner _____

Start with the calendar's daily target. Select the matching lesson inside the licensed account; no publisher lesson numbers or student placement are assumed.

Resource and role	Grade 3 lesson / target	Grade 4 lesson / target
HMH: reading and writing	_____ _____	_____ _____
HMH: assessed spelling pattern / exact TEKS	_____ _____	_____ _____
STEMscopes: paced math skill	_____ _____	_____ _____
McGraw Hill: science concept	_____ _____	_____ _____
Bridges: placement-selected intervention	_____ _____	_____ _____
Vizzle: already-taught independent practice	_____ _____	_____ _____

Three taught spelling words per learner

Grade 3: _____ _____ _____ Grade 4: _____ _____ _____

Our nine weeks of learning

October 13-December 18, 2026 | Family overview

We will learn through real books, objects, models and short investigations. Students can show learning by speaking, pointing, arranging pictures, using AAC or writing. We keep a predictable daily routine.

Week 1 | October 13 to 16

People solve problems | Books: Room on the Broom

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Find the main idea and supporting facts in a real pumpkin information book. (TEKS 3.6G, 3.7D, 3.9D(i), 3.7B). Grade 4 - Explain how the characters respond to a problem and support a message with book evidence. (TEKS 4.8B, 4.8C, 4.8A, 4.7C, 4.7B).

Math: Grade 3 - Make equal groups and find the total; then Share equally and find how many are in each group. (TEKS 3.4D, 3.4E, 3.4H, 3.4J). Grade 4 - Model division and connect the model to an equation. (TEKS 4.4E, 4.4F).

Science: Grade 3 - Show how a push or pull changes motion. (TEKS 3.7A, 3.7B). Grade 4 - Compare mixtures and show that the materials are still present. (TEKS 4.6B, 4.6C).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Recognize responsible citizenship and explain how people help their community. (TEKS 3.9C, 3.9A). Grade 4 - Identify why people explored Texas and connect an explorer to a route, goal, or result. (TEKS 4.2B, 4.2A).

Week 2 | October 19 to 23

Show what changed | Books: Big Pumpkin

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Find the main idea and supporting facts in a real pumpkin information book. (TEKS 3.9D(i), 3.6G, 3.7D, 3.7B). Grade 4 - Explain how the characters respond to a problem and support a message with book evidence. (TEKS 4.8B, 4.8C, 4.8A, 4.7C, 4.7B).

Math: Grade 3 - Share equally and find how many are in each group. (TEKS 3.4H, 3.4J). Grade 4 - Represent a two-step problem with operations, a diagram and a letter for the unknown. (TEKS 4.5A).

Science: Grade 3 - Show how a push or pull changes motion. (TEKS 3.7A, 3.7B). Grade 4 - Observe energy moving from one object to another. (TEKS 4.8A).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Recognize responsible citizenship and explain how people help their community. (TEKS 3.9A, 3.9C). Grade 4 - Connect motivations for exploration to specific explorers and outcomes. (TEKS 4.2A, 4.2B).

Week 3 | October 26 to 30

Characters take action | Books: Pumpkin Soup

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell the book's problem, actions and solution; act a scene and point to evidence. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.9C, 3.7D, 3.7B). Grade 4 - Explain how the characters respond to a problem and support a message with book evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.8B, 4.8A, 4.7C, 4.7B).

Math: Grade 3 - Share equally and find how many are in each group; then Show how two quantities change together in a table. (TEKS 3.4H, 3.4J, 3.5E). Grade 4 - Represent a two-step problem with operations, a diagram and a letter for the unknown; then Measure the space inside a rectangle and the distance around it. (TEKS 4.5A, 4.5C, 4.5D).

Science: Grade 3 - Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8A). Grade 4 - Observe energy transfer, test materials and build a closed circuit. (TEKS 4.8A, 4.8B, 4.8C).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Recognize responsible citizenship and explain how people help their community. (TEKS 3.9A, 3.9C). Grade 4 - Summarize why exploration occurred and connect explorers to outcomes. (TEKS 4.2A, 4.2B).

Week 4 | November 2 to 6

Listen and find evidence | Books: Too Many Pumpkins

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell the book's problem, actions and solution; act a scene and point to evidence. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.8B, 3.7D, 3.7B). Grade 4 - Explain how the characters respond to a problem and support a message with book evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.8A, 4.7C, 4.7B).

Math: Grade 3 - Show how two quantities change together in a table; then Name equal parts of a whole and show a fraction. (TEKS 3.5E, 3.3A, 3.3C). Grade 4 - Measure the space inside a rectangle and the distance around it. (TEKS 4.5C, 4.5D).

Science: Grade 3 - Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8A). Grade 4 - Observe how sound transfers energy. (TEKS 4.8A).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Tell the difference between kinds of sources and use a source to learn about the past. (TEKS 3.14B, 3.14F). Grade 4 - Identify a major Texas Revolution event and place it in a simple cause/event/result sequence. (TEKS 4.3B, 4.3A).

Week 5 | November 9 to 13

Small actions help | Books: The Pumpkin Book

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell the book's problem, actions and solution; act a scene and point to evidence. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D, 3.7B). Grade 4 - Explain how the characters respond to a problem and support a message with book evidence. (TEKS 4.8B, 4.8A, 4.7C, 4.7B).

Math: Grade 3 - Name equal parts of a whole and show a fraction; then Build and take apart fractions using unit fractions. (TEKS 3.3A, 3.3C, 3.3D). Grade 4 - Use a rule to complete an input-output table. (TEKS 4.5B).

Science: Grade 3 - Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8A). Grade 4 - Observe energy transfer, test materials and build a closed circuit; then Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism. (TEKS 4.8A, 4.8B, 4.8C, 4.7).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Compare information from two simple sources about the same topic. (TEKS 3.14A, 3.14B, 3.14F). Grade 4 - Identify major events/people of the Texas Revolution and connect actions to outcomes. (TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B).

Week 6 | November 16 to 20

Observe and explain | Books: A Chair for My Mother

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Retell the book's problem, actions and solution; act a scene and point to evidence. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D, 3.7B). Grade 4 - Explain how the characters respond to a problem and support a message with book evidence. (TEKS 4.8B, 4.8A, 4.7C, 4.7B).

Math: Grade 3 - Build and take apart fractions using unit fractions. (TEKS 3.3C, 3.3D). Grade 4 - Use equal-size wholes to compare fractions and explain why. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D).

Science: Grade 3 - Identify everyday forms of energy; then Test how speed relates to mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8A, 3.8B). Grade 4 - Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism. (TEKS 4.7).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Use historical sources to support one claim about the past. (TEKS 3.14A, 3.14B, 3.14F). Grade 4 - Place major events/people in order and explain one cause/effect relationship. (TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B).

Week 7 | November 30 to December 4

Create together | Books: Action Jackson

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Infer how characters work together and use that understanding to prepare a written response about the book. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.8B, 3.8A, 3.7C, 3.7B). Grade 4 - Gather and organize information from an informational art book to explain how an artist works. (TEKS 4.9D(i), 4.6G, 4.7C, 4.7B).

Math: Grade 3 - Show that different fractions can name the same amount. (TEKS 3.3F, 3.3G). Grade 4 - Use equal-size wholes to compare fractions and explain why. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D).

Science: Grade 3 - Test how speed relates to mechanical energy. (TEKS 3.8B). Grade 4 - Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism. (TEKS 4.7).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Explain how people's actions can improve a community and identify a community need/solution. (TEKS 3.1A, 3.9C, 3.2B). Grade 4 - Identify key leaders/events of the Republic of Texas and explain movement toward statehood/annexation. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D, 4.3E).

Week 8 | December 7 to 11

Use evidence to improve a design | Books: Room on the Broom

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Use character evidence to identify a theme of teamwork and strengthen a written response with text evidence. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.8B, 3.8A, 3.7C, 3.7B). Grade 4 - Gather relevant art information and organize facts under a clear central idea. (TEKS 4.9D(i), 4.6G, 4.7C, 4.7B).

Math: Grade 3 - Show that different fractions can name the same amount; then Compare fractions with the same numerator or denominator. (TEKS 3.3F, 3.3G, 3.3H). Grade 4 - Join or remove fractional parts with the same denominator. (TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B, 4.3E).

Science: Grade 3 - Test how speed relates to mechanical energy; then Demonstrate an energy idea and explain the observed evidence. (TEKS 3.8B, 3.8A). Grade 4 - Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism. (TEKS 4.7).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Identify a community problem and explain how people can work together to improve it. (TEKS 3.1A, 3.9C, 3.2B). Grade 4 - Explain one challenge/success of the Republic of Texas and connect events to annexation/statehood. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D, 4.3E).

Week 9 | December 14 to 18

Show what you learned | Books: Big Pumpkin

Reading and writing: Grade 3 - Demonstrate theme/evidence understanding and complete a written response with text evidence. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.8B, 3.8A, 3.7C, 3.7B). Grade 4 - Demonstrate central idea/research understanding and complete an informational art product. (TEKS 4.9D(i), 4.6G, 4.7C, 4.7B).

Math: Grade 3 - Compare fractions with the same numerator or denominator; then Choose a tool and measure weight or how much a container holds. (TEKS 3.3H, 3.7D, 3.7E). Grade 4 - Join or remove fractional parts with the same denominator. (TEKS 4.3A, 4.3B, 4.3E).

Science: Grade 3 - Demonstrate an energy idea and explain the observed evidence. (TEKS 3.8A, 3.8B). Grade 4 - Use a tested model to explain a force or energy transfer. (TEKS 4.7, 4.8A).

Social studies: Grade 3 - Show how an individual/group can improve a community using a problem to action to result explanation. (TEKS 3.1A, 3.9C, 3.2B). Grade 4 - Summarize one Republic/statehood event or leader and place it in the larger sequence. (TEKS 4.3C, 4.3D, 4.3E).

Friday routine

Each Friday: short spelling, reading, math and science checks. Science experiments: October 23, November 6, November 20 and December 11. The experiment provides the science check evidence. November 23-27 is fall break in this plan.

Individual learning outline

Student: _____ Current learning step: _____ Successful response mode: _____ Helpful supports: _____ Next challenge: _____ Family note: _____. IEP goals will be added after Stacie provides them.